

YICHAO ZHONG

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EDUCATION

The University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR, China
Ph.D. in Robotics

Enrolled: Sept. 2025 | Expected: June 2029

- Supervisors: Prof. **Hongyang Li**, Prof. **Jia Pan**

Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Shanghai, China
Bachelor of Computer Science

Enrolled: Sept. 2021 | Graduated: June 2025

- Member of **ACM Honor Class**, an elite CS program for the top 5% of students
- GPA**: 3.80/4.3

EXPERIENCE

OpenDriveLab, **HKU**

Hong Kong SAR, China

PhD Student, advised by Prof. Hongyang Li

Sept. 2025 – Present

Research Topic: Humanoid Reinforcement Learning at Scale; RoboNaldo

Robotics Lab, **Horizon Robotics**

Shanghai, China

Intern Researcher, advised by Tianwei Lin

Aug. 2025

Research Topic: Real-World RL on Manipulators

Embodied AI Center, **Shanghai AI Lab**

Shanghai, China

Undergraduate Researcher, advised by Prof. Weinan Zhang

Mar. 2025 – Jun. 2025

Research Topic: Cross-embodiment learning, humanoid locomotion

LeCAR Lab, **Carnegie Mellon University**

Pittsburgh, PA, United States

Undergraduate Researcher, advised by Prof. Guanya Shi

Jun. 2024 – Dec. 2024

Research Topic: Robot learning; safe control; adaptive control

APEX Knowledge and Data Management Lab, **Shanghai Jiao Tong University**

Shanghai, China

Undergraduate Researcher, advised by Prof. Weinan Zhang and Prof. Yong Yu

Aug. 2023 – Jun. 2025

Research Topic: Reinforcement learning algorithms; robotics

PUBLICATIONS

RoboNaldo: Accurate, Stable and Powerful Humanoid Soccer Shooting via Motion-Guided Curriculum Reinforcement Learning

Y. Zhong*, Y. Lu*, Y. Lu, T. Tang, H. Mai, Y. Pan, T. Li, L. Chen, J. Wang, Z. Li*, P. Lu*, H. Li*

- arXiv preprint · arXiv:2606.11092

Sparse Video Generation Propels Real-World Beyond-the-View Vision-Language Navigation

H. Zhang*, S. Liang*, L. Chen, Y. Li, Y. Xu, **Y. Zhong**, F. Zhang, H. Li

- In submission · arXiv:2602.05827

Bridging Adaptivity and Safety: Learning Agile Collision-Free Locomotion Across Varied Physics

Y. Zhong, C. Zhang, T. He, G. Shi

- Accepted to **L4DC 2025** · arXiv:2501.04276

Diffusion Models for Reinforcement Learning: A Survey 

Z. Zhu, H. Zhao, H. He, **Y. Zhong**, S. Zhang, Y. Yu, W. Zhang

- arXiv:2311.01223

COURSE PROJECTS

Compiler for Mx* Language

SJTU ACM Class Compiler Design and Implementation 2022 (MS208 Course Project)

- Compiler from Mx* (a C++/Java-like language) to RV32I Assembly; implemented optimizations (Mem2Reg, inlining, etc.) achieving 3rd place in ACM Class 2021.

RISC-V CPU Implemented in Verilog RTL

SJTU ACM Class Computer Architecture 2022 (MS108 Course Project)

- Tomasulo RISC-V CPU with instruction cache and 2-bit saturating counter branch predictor.

Kinematic Motion Diffusion: Towards Semantic-adaptive Motion Synthesis via Kinematic Guidance

SJTU Computer Vision 2023 Course Project

- Accepted to International Conference on Multimedia Systems and Signal Processing (ICMSSP), 2024

HONORS & AWARDS

Mathematical Modeling Competitions

- COMAP MCM/ICM 2022, Honorable Mention (Top 30% worldwide)
- National Mathematical Modelling Competition 2022, Second Prize in Shanghai

Scholarships

- Zhiyuan Honorary Scholarship, 2021–2024 (Top 2% at SJTU)
- Longfor Scholarship (CS Only), 2022 (Top <1% among CS students at SJTU)

OTHER EXPERIENCES

Reinforcement Learning — *Teaching Assistant*

Jan. 2025 – June 2025

Compiler Design and Implementation — *Teaching Assistant*

Sept. 2023 – Jan. 2024

Programming — *Teaching Assistant*

Sept. 2022 – Jan. 2023

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Chinese (Mandarin), English (TOEFL: 105 — R27, L29, S23, W26)
- **Programming:** C, C++, C#, Python, Java, MATLAB, Verilog
- **Tools & Frameworks:** Git, $\LaTeX$, PyTorch, TensorFlow, ROS, Unity